

SKILLS GUIDE



Excellent communication skills to be able to work with non-technical staff in an organization.



The ability to work as part of a team of software developers and other IT professionals.



The efficient management of IT technicians and an ability to support senior managers.



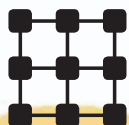
The ability to identify and solve technical problems within urgent time frames.



Patience and perseverance to resolve problems and restore a company's network function.



Knowledge and expertise across a wide range of IT software, hardware, and networks.



NETWORK CONTROLLER

Manages the staff who maintain the network, and ensures the network operates reliably.



IT CONSULTANT Works for an IT consultancy or sets up their own business to provide networking advice and services to a range of clients.



HELP DESK PROFESSIONAL

Provides telephone and online support and advice to a company's network users.

AT A GLANCE



YOUR INTERESTS Information Technology (IT) • Computer science • Electronic or electrical engineering • Computer networks • Mathematics



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS

A technical degree in computer-systems engineering or another related subject is useful but not required.



LIFESTYLE Network engineers work shifts or are on call to resolve issues outside normal hours, as companies rely on their networks 24 hours a day.



LOCATION Much of the work is office-based, but some network engineers operate remotely from home, depending on the type of project.



THE REALITIES Technological advances mean this is a growth area with many new fields of work opening up. Skills need to be regularly updated.

RELATED CAREERS

- ▶ **SOFTWARE ENGINEER** *see pp. 118–119*
- ▶ **SYSTEMS ANALYST** *see pp. 120–121*
- ▶ **DATABASE ADMINISTRATOR** *see pp. 122–123*
- ▶ **CYBERSECURITY ANALYST** *see pp. 132–133*

The US Bureau of Labor Statistics predicts that the number of job opportunities for network engineers will grow 18 percent by 2018.